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THE VIRAL POST HEIST

How I made AI scrape, study, and reverse-engineer 300+ top-performing social posts in one night, then write and schedule 30 days of content in my voice.

Inside: the exact method, the exact prompts, the scripts, and the formulas it found. So you can run the same heist on your own competitors.

● THE RECEIPTS, BEFORE YOU READ ANYTHING

19 Instagram reels, each over 1,000,000 plays, **33.1M** plays combined, full transcripts pulled.

105 TikToks analyzed, including winners with **5.9%** share rates.

106 LinkedIn posts mined for the text-post formula.

30 LinkedIn posts written in my voice and scheduled at 6:00 PM daily. By an AI. In one sitting.

Every number in this document is from my actual runs in August 2026. Nothing is projected, estimated, or made up. That is a rule where I come from.

• WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

One evening I gave an AI assistant two things: a cheap scraping API key and one instruction.

"Study the top performing content on Instagram. Figure out what makes it work. Build me a repository."

A few hours later I had a folder on my computer containing every Instagram reel over one million plays from the accounts and niches I care about, with full captions, AI transcripts of every video, engagement metrics, and a written analysis of why each one worked.

Then we did TikTok. Then LinkedIn. Then it took the LinkedIn formula, wrote 30 daily posts in my voice using my real stories, and scheduled every single one for 6:00 PM.

Total cost of the scraping: about two dollars in API credits. The AI did the reading, the analyzing, the writing, and the scheduling.

The stack (three pieces)

PIECE	WHAT I USED	NOTES
An AI agent	Claude (Claude Code, the terminal version)	Any AI assistant that can run scripts works. The terminal versions can actually execute the scraping, not just talk about it.
A scraping API	Scrape Creators (scrapecreators.com)	Public social data via simple API calls. About 1 credit per request, no logins, no cookies, no gray areas. Alternatives exist; this one covers IG, TikTok, YouTube, LinkedIn, Facebook and the ad libraries.
One evening	Mine happened to be a Friday	The first run is the slow one. Refreshes take minutes because everything is saved and re-runs are free.

Why this beats "content inspiration"

Most people write content by vibes. Some people study winners by scrolling and screenshotting. This method is different in one important way: **it is measured**. You are not guessing what worked. You are reading the actual transcript of a reel that did 6.3 million plays 12 days ago, next to the actual transcript of one that did 1.3 million, and letting an AI find what they share.

Patterns found across 19 winners are not opinions. They are evidence.

• THE METHOD: FIVE STEPS

Step 1. Pick your targets

Choose 8 to 12 accounts: your competitors, the big names in your niche, and 2 or 3 adjacent accounts whose audience you want. Add 3 to 5 search keywords your customers actually type.

Step 2. Pull the winners

The AI writes a small script that calls the API for each account, saves every response to disk, then filters to posts above a threshold from the last 30 days. My thresholds: 1M+ plays on IG and TikTok, top engagement on LinkedIn. Yours can be 10x smaller in a local niche; the method is identical.

```
> python3 pull.py accounts hormozi garyvee codiesanchez ...
> python3 pull.py search "ai side hustle" "chatgpt"
> python3 pull.py filter
19 winners (>= 1,000,000 plays, <= 30d) -> data/winners.json
```

Step 3. Pull the words, not just the numbers

This is the step almost everyone skips. The metrics tell you WHICH posts won. The captions and transcripts tell you WHY. One API call per winner returns the full spoken transcript of any reel or TikTok. Now the hooks are text you can study, not vibes you remember.

Step 4. Extract the formula

Feed every transcript and caption back to the AI and ask it to find what the winners share: the opening lines, the structures, the lengths, the CTA mechanics. This produces your niche's actual playbook. Mine found things I would never have guessed (page 5).

Step 5. Same skeleton, your stories

The last prompt matters most. You do not copy anyone's content. You copy the **skeleton** and re-body it with your own true stories, your own numbers, your own voice. Then the AI drafts a 30-day calendar and, if your posting tool has an API, schedules everything.

The rule that keeps this honest: steal structures, never sentences. A formula is not plagiarism. It is anatomy.

● THE PROMPTS (COPY, PASTE, RUN)

Written for an AI agent that can run code (Claude Code or similar). If yours cannot, ask it to give you the scripts to run yourself.

Prompt 1: The scrape

```
Here is my Scrape Creators API key: [KEY]. Build me a repository of top content in [MY NICHE]. Pull the recent posts of these accounts: [LIST]. Also search these keywords: [LIST]. Save every raw API response to disk so we never pay for the same request twice. Then filter to posts with [THRESHOLD]+ views posted in the last 30 days and rank them. Show me the table.
```

Prompt 2: The autopsy

```
For every winner: pull the full transcript and caption. Then write a card per post: the exact opening line, the structure beat by beat, the length, the CTA, and your analysis of why this one crossed [THRESHOLD] when the account's median post did not.
```

Prompt 3: The formula

```
Read all the cards together. Find what the winners share that the losers lack: hook patterns with verbatim examples, format structures, duration bands, caption mechanics, CTA mechanics. Write it as a playbook with rules I can follow, each rule backed by the numbers behind it. No generic advice. If the data does not show it, do not write it.
```

Prompt 4: The rewrite

```
Here are 10 true stories from my business: [STORIES]. Take the winning skeletons from the playbook and re-body them with my stories. My voice: [3 ADJECTIVES + A WRITING SAMPLE]. Rules: no invented numbers, no fake claims, hooks under 12 words with a number where possible, one clear CTA. Draft 30 posts.
```

Prompt 5: The machine

```
Schedule these 30 posts daily at [TIME] using [MY TOOL]. Confirm each one is scheduled. Then set up a monthly refresh: re-pull the winners, update the playbook, flag any new format that is breaking out this month.
```

• WHAT THE DATA ACTUALLY SAID

Condensed from my runs. Your niche will differ. That is the point of running it yourself.

The universal hook rules (every 1M+ winner, every platform)

- **A number in the first sentence.** "70% chance." "\$15 billion." "At 27, making \$40,000." Specificity reads as evidence; vagueness reads as content.
- **Claim first, credentials second.** "The vitamin world is giving the wrong advice"... then "I am a neurologist." Never the bio first.
- **A question the viewer must stay to answer, inside 5 seconds.**
- **Emotional whiplash beats one emotion.** The flip is the hook: complaint into compliment, triumph into tragedy.

Platform physics nobody tells you

FINDING	THE NUMBER BEHIND IT
On IG, comment-keyword DM gates dominate	11 of 19 one-million-play reels used "Comment WORD and I will DM you X"
Faces matter on IG	19 of 19 winners were person-on-camera
On TikTok, shares are the ranking fuel	Top winner: 1.1M shares on 18.9M plays, a 5.9% share rate
TikTok duration is bimodal	Winners are under 15 seconds or 2 to 6 minutes; the 45 second tip video is the dead zone
Carousels are a depth weapon, not reach	One carousel: 1,407 comments on 7,700 likes. Reels never touch that ratio
On LinkedIn, comments-to-likes is the tell	Best creator posts run 30 to 45 percent comment-to-like ratios, driven by genuine question closers
Small accounts break out with series, not spikes	One account: 164k followers on just 86 posts, a named series in every video

The LinkedIn text formula (the one this document's post used on you)

Flat absurd opener under 12 words. Short lines. Quoted dialogue as the comedy engine. One real number. A turn where the joke reveals a lesson. A genuine question close. 400 to 1,100 characters. No hashtag soup.

• THE SAME HEIST, POINTED AT OTHER THINGS

Scrape, analyze, generate is a loop. Content is just the most visible place to run it. The same evening of work applies to:

- **Competitor ads.** The Meta, TikTok, Google and LinkedIn ad libraries are public. Pull every ad your competitor is running, how long each has been live (longevity = it works), and let AI extract their angles before you spend a dollar.
 - **Reviews mining.** Scrape the reviews of every competitor. AI clusters the complaints. Their one-star reviews are your ad copy and your product roadmap.
 - **Pricing and offer intel.** Watch competitor pricing pages and offers change over time, automatically.
 - **Hiring signals.** Competitor job posts tell you what they are building next, months early.
 - **Your own niche's breakout accounts.** My scripts flag small accounts growing abnormally fast, so you see the format that is about to win while it is still early.
-

• THINGS I COULD BUILD FOR YOU

I build systems like this for a living. Real builds, real costs, no course, no retainer required. A few that start conversations:

- **A competitor content radar.** Weekly automated pull of your competitors' best content and ads, delivered as a digest with the "why it worked" analysis included.
- **A content engine in your voice.** Your true stories + your niche's measured formula, drafted monthly, scheduled automatically, with a comment-gate DM system so posts build your list.
- **Review and market intel dashboards.** Every competitor's reviews, clustered by complaint, refreshed on schedule.
- **AI agents for the boring work.** Intake, quotes, follow-up, meeting notes into tasks. The unglamorous automations that quietly return hours every week.
- **Custom internal tools.** CRMs, client portals, job trackers. Built in days because AI writes most of the code and I make sure it actually works.

Want one of these, or the content heist run on your niche?

DM me on LinkedIn (Neil Busque) or visit **busqueneil.com**. Tell me your niche and your top 3 competitors. I will tell you exactly what I would build and what it costs. No call required.

Who wrote this

Neil Busque. Based in New Jersey. IT first, then a decade across every kind of marketing, and now AI lets me build again: CRMs, client portals, automation systems, and content machines like the one in this PDF. I publish what I learn at busqueneil.com and on LinkedIn.

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